

Red river hog

Potamochoerus porcus

Tufted ears, a fox-red coat, and a white spinal stripe make Africa’s smallest wild pig a striking animal. What the red river hog lacks in size, it makes up for in strength. Its muscular, stocky body and wedge-shaped head are designed to dig up the hardest ground for roots, tubers, and other food.

Nocturnal foragers

Mostly active at night, red river hogs are strong swimmers, and can forage in water as well as on land. Small family groups are usually found resting in a burrow or undergrowth during the day. Unfortunately, their fondness for agricultural crops brings them into conflict with humans, their main persecutors.



long, pointed ears with prominent white tufts

facial hair fluffed out when threatened, making hog appear larger and more intimidating

- ↔ 3–5 ft (0.9–1.5 m)
- ⚖ 100–290 lb (46–132 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌿 Grass, roots, tubers, snails
- 🏠 🌳



W. to
C. Africa

▷ **DOMINANT BOAR**
Only male red river hogs have large warts in front of their eyes, whereas both sexes have tusks.

Common pangolin

Manis tricuspis

Pangolins are covered in overlapping scales made of keratin, a material found in hair and fingernails. When threatened, these burrowing mammals roll themselves up into a ball to protect their underparts—the only area of their body that is not covered in tough scales.

The common African pangolin feeds mainly on termites and, to a lesser extent, ants, gathering the insects with its long, sticky, muscular tongue. It is able to seal its nostrils and ears shut to protect them from stings and bites as it feeds. The pangolin has no teeth, and special muscles in its mouth keep insects in place once sucked inside. Its muscular stomach contains keratin spines, and the pangolin also swallows stones to help crush its food, ready for digestion.



- ↔ 10–17 in (25–43 cm)
- ⚖ 4–7 lb (1.8–3.2 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🌿 Termites, ants
- 🏠 🌳 🦞



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◁ **FIFTH LIMB**
The common pangolin uses its long, strong, prehensile tail to maneuver around in trees.